

Coptic Ostraca in the Museo Archeologico at Milan and some others.



As Professor Calderini has kindly offered me the hospitality of these pages and has supplied me with photographs of the Milan ostraca, I gladly take the opportunity of publishing them. He permits me to add a few others in my own possession (nos. IX to XII), which had been omitted from my *Short Texts*. Of these no. IX was given me by Mr. R. Engelbach, no. X by the late Mr. E. R. Ayrton, nos. XI, XII by Mr. R. Mond.

All these ostraca doubtless came from Thebes or its vicinity: the places named in II, IV and IX, besides the script of II and III, prove it in these cases at least. All may be assigned to the 6th or 7th century.

Abbreviations: — *BKU.* = *Berliner Koptische Urkunden*, Bd. I. *BM.* = *Catal. Copt. MSS.*, British Museum. *CO.* = Crum, *Coptic Ostraca*, 1902. Hall = H. R. Hall, *Coptic and Greek Texts*, 1905. *Ryl.* = *Catal. Copt. MSS.*, J. Rylands Library. *ST.* = Crum, *Short Texts*, 1921.

I

Limestone. Complete.

<i>Recto.</i>	ⲡ ⲛⲁⲓⲧⲓⲣⲓ ⲙⲡⲣⲱⲙ [ⲉ] ⲉⲧⲉⲙ ⲡⲉⲩⲱ 5 ⲕ ⲉⲙ ⲡⲱ[ⲟ] ⲭⲛⲉ	<i>Verso.</i>	ⲛⲡⲁⲥⲉⲃⲛⲥ ⲙⲡⲉⲩⲁ[ⲉⲣ ⲣⲁⲧⲉ] 10 ⲉⲓⲧⲉⲩⲓⲛ ⲛⲛ ⲣⲉⲩⲣ ⲛⲁⲃⲉ [ⲙ]ⲡⲉⲩⲙⲟ[ⲟⲥ]
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Psalm I, v. 1. This verse (? a protective amulet) is found upon other ostraca: Hall. p. 74 (the Greek of it, *ib.*, p. 23).

II

Limestone. Almost complete. By scribe of CO. 71 etc. ('Hand A').
Printed as ST., no. 122.

List of missing objects.

- + πωτὰ πῶνλν[
 τῶνγε πῆατ ἡπι[
 αὐω κεσοῦν πείδος [ον πῆα]τ ἡ
 πῆζε εροῦν αὐω πποτη[ροπλν]της
 5 ἡπαπας σανεειρε ἡππ[σπτ]ε
 αὐω ἡβαρατε ἡαβραζαμ σαχ[o π]
 τσε ἡππδπτοῦ αὐω πογντ.
 ηδαγειδ ραζτ ἡππδπτ
 ηαι δε τηρου θνλν ἡαπα
 10 [α]παπιας ψαατ ἡμοου

(blank)

2 Doubtless ἡππζε, or ἡππδπ-. 3 The *lacuna* is longer than is allowed for in ST. 5 Not [ζε, as tail of ζ would have been visible. 7 After τ possibly 2 letters lost. 9 Read πτααπα.

« The things lacking¹ of the chattels (ῶλη) [.....], the silver altar² we [have] not [found]; and six other things (εἶδος) [besides of] silver have we not found; and the ποτηροπλῦτης³ of Papas, (the) dealer⁴, have we not [found]; and the (objects of) brass (?)⁵ of Abraham, the scribe of Tse⁶, have we not found; and the of David, (the) fuller, have we not found. All these, then (δέ), are the chattels (ῶλη) which Apa Ananias has lacked⁷. »

¹ πτα known in Achm. (*Clem. ὑστέρημα*) and Sa. (CSCO. 73, 213, CO. 95).

² A portable altar perhaps; cf. ST. 125. But Paris 44, 60 gives ῶνγε = ῶγορη and *mibkhara* and *migmara* as equivalents for both; thus it might here be a censor.

³ Cf. ST. 92 and Herwerden s. v.

⁴ εἶρε presumably the rare word in CO. 218. In an unpublished Br. Mus. pap., in a list of irrigation implements, εἶρε πῶνι = υδροκομος (?). The meaning is still obscure.

- ⁵ Assuming this to be plur. of Ⲭⲁⲣⲱⲧ.
- ⁶ The scribe (v. CO. 36) of a village often named in Theban texts: CO. 492 n. Whether identical with the site of one of the Pachomian convents (*Miss.* IV 535) can hardly be suggested until the topography of these settlements is better ascertained.
- ⁷ One may ask in what sense Ananias 'lacked' these things, which apparently belonged to others. Probably the church or monastery so named (CO. 212) is here intended. Perhaps Papas and Abraham had presented to it the objects missing. Coptic inventories of church property have survived, e. g. CO. 459, Ryl. 238.

III

Limestone. Incomplete.

Recto. ⲧⲱⲣⲡ ⲙⲓⲛ ⲧⲱⲛⲉ ⲉⲧⲉⲕ] *Verso.* 5]ⲉⲓ ⲡⲉⲓ
 ⲙⲡⲧⲱⲛⲣⲉ [ⲡⲭⲟⲉⲓⲥ ⲉⲓⲉⲥ] ⲙⲉⲓⲣⲟ [ⲧⲁⲁⲥ ⲙⲓ
 ⲙⲟⲩ ⲉⲣⲟⲕ [ⲡⲁⲱⲛⲣⲉ ⲉⲓ
 ⲡⲟⲩ ⲉⲧⲉⲕ [ⲧⲡⲃⲓⲕⲧⲱⲣ

Letter from Victor to his « son » (name lost). The scribe is either he of CO., pl. I, E. 301 etc. ('Hand D'), or one writing a very similar hand. The opening formula (« First I greet thy sonship; may the Lord bless thee ») is that often used by bishop Abraham¹; but apparently it is not reserved for bishops.

¹ CO. 53, 54, 57, 61, 62, BKU. I. no. 318.

IV

Pottery. Incomplete.

ⲉⲧⲟ [ⲙⲡⲧⲙⲉ [

ⲉⲧⲡⲡⲟ [ⲟⲩ ⲁⲓ ⲉⲱⲁⲕⲕⲓ

ⲉⲙⲡⲁⲛ [10] ? ⲙⲡⲁⲥⲭⲁ

ⲡⲁⲣ ⲙⲡ [ⲧⲁⲁⲥ ⲙⲡⲁⲉⲓⲱⲧ

5 ⲓⲥⲓ ⲙⲡⲁ [] ? ⲡⲣⲉⲥⲃⲓ

ⲡⲧ ⲉⲓⲥⲉⲛⲧⲉ ⲓⲱⲥⲛ]ⲫ ⲡⲣⲙⲉⲁⲗ

ⲉⲁⲛⲉⲧⲁⲕ [] .. ⲱⲣⲡⲁⲡⲁⲥ

A Letter, addressed by Joseph, calling himself « the servant » (13), to « his father ». The name Papas, in last line, is perhaps that of another person greeted. In 4 one might read the place-name Papat, known from other Theban texts ¹. In 6 it would be possible to read [Ermo]nt: in 3, if a place, either Pan[kalêla ²], Pan[kamê ³], or Pan[ge ⁴].

¹ Crum-Steindorff, *K. Rechtsurk.*, no. 97, 91, ST. 429.

² CO. 127.

³ Crum-Steindorff, *op. cit.* 110, 2.

⁴ Cairo, stele 8519.

V

Pottery. Incomplete.

] . ωρ ἡτεπερ .[ωω]
 πε παῖ κεκαρς εἰπαεῖ
 χαριστα ἡτο[οτκ]
 ταας ἡπαρ[ον βικ]
 5 τωρ ἡπρ[εσβ'
 πειε[

A Letter, addressed to Victor, a priest ¹. The writer asks a favour, promising his gratitude (εὐχαριστεῖν ²), and perhaps gives himself the epithet ἐλάχιστος (6).

Between ll. 3 and 4 are traces of an earlier text.

¹ Or ? prior, προσετώς; cf. CO. 210, 332.

² Exactly as in CO. 64, 365, Ad. 22.

VI

Limestone. Incomplete.

[+ ο]γωω ἡκ[? ἡ]
 τ[εγ]νοῦ εἰκπα
 χι πεπα[α]ζ
 παταροι ε
 5 ρογη ἡπ
 παγ

Letter. « Please ¹, do thou , so soon as thou shalt receive this tablet (πλζζ), (thou) shalt meet ² me forthwith ».

¹ Corresponds to θέλησον.

² τὰρο εἰσὶν thus in CO. 377; cf. *ib.* Ad. 40, where τ. εἰσὶν has the same meaning.

VII

Pottery. Incomplete. Printed as ST. 386.

] · τ̄χ̄π̄ογ̄ι ρ̄α[
 ωε μαρεφειωε η[ιω]
 ρ̄αηηηε π̄π̄φωρ[κ
 παβαῖωρ̄κ ἀπο[
 5 μα π̄μ̄ εὑπαχ[
 εττωω μ̄μ̄[
 φογωω εμ[
 ἀῖσω̄. [
 εφ. [

The name « John » occurs (3); perhaps it is he who is to take an oath (*ib.*). « My oath-bearer » (4) is a new word; perhaps « he that swears in support of me ». L. 5 looks like the clause in a legal undertaking, requiring its validity « in every place where it shall be displayed », (here? χ̄π̄ογ̄ « enquired into » or χ̄οογ̄ « send »); but the rest of the text points rather to a Letter.

VIII

Pottery. Incomplete.

ϣ̄ ειωτ[
 τὰρο μ̄πα[
 καλει π̄τε[
 χ̄εκαε εκ[πατη]
 5 ποογ[
 πα[

A Letter. L. 1 was not the first, though the chrysmon clearly precedes it. There must, in the lost line, have been πα- « my (father »), or some such introductory word. In 2 ταρο υπα[ρα]-καλει, « attain to entreating »¹, seems improbable; a longer gap is more likely.

¹ Cf. ταρο in ST. 241, CO. 90, Aeg. Zeit. 1885, 68.

IX

Pottery. Complete.

Mortgage of a house. A similar document is *Jême* no. 58.

† ἀποκ ιωσηφ
 πρ̄μανηνητ παι ετοϋνηζ ρμ
 illegible πωτ...πρ̄μοητ
 χεεπει διουωζ ρμπα ετμμ̄αυ αιρ ρωβ δι
 5 ταρο ουκωζ μα δικωτ ουη̄ι ηζητητ τε
 ποϋ εις ρηητε αιρ χρια ποϋρωβ παναρεον
 αιχι εχωι ητοοτϋ παβραζαμ ηπετροс η
 сπαϋ ητρεμεсιон ποϋβ етаχρια τω̄ι
 тепоϋ τεχριωсте μοοϋ πακ αϋω теοϋωζ η
 10 тоотк ηπηι ετμμ̄αυ παι ετρωп ρμηροι η
 [τ]μηητε ητοκ ετο ηχοεις ηπηι ετμμ̄αυ
 ραπεксπαϋ ητρεμεсιон χεπεζααϋ ηρωμε
 ρααηφιβαζε πακ ρароϋ ητοκ ετο ηπεϋ
 χοεις ψαητεκμωζ ηπεксπαϋ тρεмесιон
 15 ἀποκ ιωσηφ πρ̄μανηνηт тестеχ̄ει ατ[εβλ]
 χε ουωρх παкте ουχοεiste μα ηιμ [сoϋωηζ]
 εβoλ ηζηтс ηταιсζαι · ηη. [
] .. ραχαριαс ηеисаκ [
] αβρ. [
]

« I, Joseph, the man of the north ¹, he that dwells in ? ² of Ermont, (say,) Seeing that (ἐπεὶ) I have dwelt in the above-named place and have (5) acquired a piece of ground ³ and built a house therein; now lo, I had need (χρῆζις) of something important (ἐνδεχόμενος) and I took upon me from Abraham, son of Peter, (a loan of) 2 gold *tremisia* for my own need (χρῆζις). Now I owe (χρεωστέον) them to you and I cede (10) to you the above-named house, which is in the midmeadow ⁴. You it is are lord of the above-named house, in return for your 2 *tremisia*. (I declare) that no man shall be able to dispute (ἀντιβλέπειν) ⁵ with you respecting it. You it is are its lord, until you shall be paid your 2 *tremisia*. (15) I, Joseph, the man of the north, I assent (συγχέειν) to this sherd; it is a confirmation for you and is valid in every place wherein it may [be exhibited]. I have written Zacharias ⁶, son of Isaac ... »

¹ Or perhaps a place-name: cf. ST. 131, 222 (= ΔΗΗΤ, or cf. *Toronto*, no. 3 ΔΗΤ), Hall p. 97 *inf.*, perhaps CO. 89.

² One expects the name in 10, 11, but I cannot read it here.

³ Cf. Ryl. 357 as here, *BKU*. I, 135, ΠΚΩΘ ΠΕΙΩΘΕ.

⁴ Cf. ST. 155. Doubtful whether a true place-name, or merely intended to distinguish one meadow among several.

⁵ ΘΑ- must stand for Θ- = Θ, as often.

⁶ Presumably a witness.

X

Pottery. Complete.

Record of a labourer's work.

ⲡ ⲟⲩⲃⲟⲟⲩ ⲛ
 ⲛⲁⲛⲃⲁⲗⲟⲩ
 ⲙⲁ ⲁⲗⲁⲩⲉⲓⲗ ⲁⲗⲉ
 ⲃⲉⲧⲏⲛⲃⲉ ⲙⲡⲧⲩⲥ
 5 ⲛⲱⲉ ⲛⲧⲱⲃⲉ ⲉⲗⲉ
 ⲏⲏⲧⲟⲩ ⲃⲉⲧⲉⲃⲉ
 blank

« A day of wages (ἀνάλωμα ¹) which David did in our presence: 1900 bricks did he bring to (us) ². »

¹ Ἀνάλωμα varies sometimes with δαπάνη, δαίριον, τροφή. Here it is presumably wage in kind. Cf. its use in CO. 361, ST. 43, WZKM. 1902, 258, *BKU*. I, 48 vo. (= *Aeg. Z.* 1878, 19).

² Reading ⲃⲉⲧⲉⲛⲃⲉ; cf. 4.

XI

Limestone. Complete.

Record of a weaver's work.

+ ρμε ρμην
 ππαδϣ nen
 ταλαγειδ
 ριστου παϊ
 5 ρατϣκη
 blank

«Fortyeight (pieces of) linen¹ has David woven² for me, from each pair³.»

¹ Reading ιαδϣ. The 2d α was altered from ϣ.

² On this word v. Spiegelberg, *Kopt. Etymol.* no. 36. This pronominal form testifies to the existence of the verb (cf. Hall p. 120, Turaieff *Materiale* no. 13, BM. 585, 16). The instance in Mat. VI 28 = Lu. XII 27 is not conclusive, since ριϣε there may = ϣοπιϣν; while in *Mus. Guimet* XVII 103 the Greek σπρέψε (*Vita* § 55) suggests rather ριτε.

³ With ζυγή written thus cf. *Jême* no. 16, 23, *BGU*. I 308, BM. 1103. It occurs joined with *velum* ST. 200, with σαβάνιον Ryl. 246, 334, ϣτην BM. I. c., ϣαρίσιον *Jême* I. c. See also Bell's note, P.Lond. IV, p. 299. In the present case we must suppose the weaver to have been supplied with a number of 'pairs' of raw flax, while 'linen' indicates the completed length or roll.

XII

Limestone. Complete.

Letter from two anchorites presumably, to two others.

αποκ πατλο[c
 μ]παδρων τη
 ϣ[ιη]ε ενεμμερ
 ατα (sic) πσπηϣ σαμοϣ

- 5 ⲛⲗ ⲙⲡⲕⲩⲣⲓⲁⲕⲟⲥ
 ⲧⲏⲡⲁⲣⲁⲕⲁⲗⲉⲓ ⲟⲩⲏ
 ⲡⲧⲉⲧⲏⲙⲏⲧⲙⲁⲓ
 ⲡⲟⲩⲧⲉ ⲉⲧⲣⲉⲧⲉⲧⲏ
 ⲭⲉⲕⲟ ⲧⲏⲟⲃ ⲡⲁⲣⲁ
 10 [ⲡⲏ ⲉ]ⲃⲟⲗ ⲡⲙⲙⲁⲏ ⲡⲧ
 [...ⲕ]ⲟⲩⲓ ⲙⲙⲟⲟⲩ ⲉⲡⲙⲁ
 [ⲙⲡ]ⲉⲛⲧⲁⲧⲉⲧⲏⲧⲁⲗⲉ ⲡⲁⲏ
 ⲡⲏⲁⲣⲁⲡⲏ ⲙⲙⲟⲏ ⲁⲩⲧⲁ
 ⲙⲟⲏ ⲭⲉⲁⲉⲩⲣⲣ ⲭⲣⲉⲁ ⲙⲁ[ⲧ]
 15 ⲉ blank

« I, Paul and Aaron, we greet our beloved brethren, Samuel (5) and Cyriacus, and we beg (ⲡⲁⲣⲁⲕⲁⲗⲉⲓⲛ ⲟⲩⲏ) your piety that you would complete the great charity (ⲁⲩⲭⲁⲣⲏⲧⲏ) (10) toward (*lit.* with) us by¹ a little water, in place [of that] which you (formerly) gave us in charity (ⲁⲩⲭⲁⲣⲏⲧⲏ). For we have been told that there is great need (ⲭⲣⲉⲓⲗ) ² (thereof). »

¹ The *lacuna* is too short for [ⲉⲧⲏⲧ ⲟⲩⲕ] « and would give » ; while [ⲉ ⲟⲩⲕ] « of », is scarcely grammatical.

² Lit. « that they have need greatly ». ⲣⲣ of course for ⲣ.

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